

Michael Ketigian

Brand strategist, operations leader & poet

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I help founders and executive teams express complex ideas through brand strategy, messaging and copy. My work draws on an engineering education, experience managing software teams and business operations, and a parallel practice in poetry and performance.

Selected client work michaelxmachina.com/work/

Professional experience

Symantic Studio

2020-present · Remote

Owner / Operator, Independent Consultant

Brand, content and product strategy and copywriting, primarily for technology companies. Selected engagements:

Everyday Dose · Recurring engagements, 2021-2026

Established brand and content guidelines with the founder and core team in Year 1. Led copywriting across the website, social media, products and merchandise. Developed a science-first, accessible voice and contributed to operational workflows in Years 1 and 2.

Astroscale · 2024-2025

Brand strategy, content strategy and copywriting across the aerospace company's global and US brands.

Matter Venture Partners & Ursa Major

Worked directly with Matter's founders on brand strategy, messaging and copy. Refined Ursa Major's brand strategy and messaging with its executive team, then developed content and copy.

Other clients include Meritech Capital, Merlyn Mind, OfferFit, Civic and Veryfi. Selected projects with design partners Dakotomy and Future Works.

Good Market

2018-2019 · Remote

Project Manager, Operations

Sourced and managed a distributed software development team to launch a nonprofit digital marketplace for people-and-planet-first businesses.

Independent Consultant

2016-2018 · Colombo / Remote

Branding, Writing & Operations

Branding and copywriting, freelance journalism, and the launch and management of a coworking space with a local partner.

Professional experience, continued**Hackerati**

2013–2015 · New York

Director of Operations

Led business development, marketing, recruiting and events, reporting to the cofounders. Led Agile engineering and design teams as a Scrum-certified project manager. The software consultancy served Huffington Post, Viacom, SMEs and startups. Coordinated and presented at two UN events.

Mini-Circuits

2012 · New York

RF & Microwave Engineer

Developed and tested RF and microwave components for a global manufacturer.

Independent AI systems work**neXus**

2026 · Lisbon

Independent project, product owner & architect

Directs AI agents as an engineering team to build an orchestration and project-management system. Sets goals, designs workflows and verifies results; agents write the code.

Experiments with continuity across providers, local voice interaction and records of which agent produced work. Studies failures in daily use, including false completion claims and drift from instructions, and tests human oversight and review processes.

Selected public communication

- **Climate Hub, Davos, 2025.** "[Regenerative Roadshow](#)", a performative keynote led by Chad Frischmann of Project Drawdown and RegenIntel. Served as his rap translator.
- **UN General Assembly, 2020.** Composed a [live Rap Up](#) during the main Digital Cooperation event and performed it as the closing.
- **IDEA Week, Notre Dame, 2019.** [Moderated a blockchain and entrepreneurship panel](#) and performed a Rap Up opening for Bill Nye.

Education**The Cooper Union**

2012 · New York

Bachelor of Science in Engineering

Focus on electrical engineering and integrated systems. Thesis project on real-time indoor location tracking via RFID.

Full-tuition scholarship · Dean's List